THE OTHER ROBIN

The game, as it plays now

Robin Ryu · Koro

The prologue and the day after.
34 scenes.
Every line of dialogue as the game speaks it;
the stretches you play marked PLAYABLE.

PROLOGUE

COLD OPEN — BLACK 1

Black. Rain, the hum of a city, a siren that never arrives. A click. A single red light in the dark.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Ten years ago, the weapons got small enough to wear.

EXT. THE SKY OVER NEW YORK — NIGHT 2

Falling through cloud — thick, then thinning as the skyline appears. Drones at every depth.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
A ring. A bracelet. A pair of shoes.

Three glimpses as she names them: a commuter on a roof terrace turns their hand and a RING catches red; a courier weaving through traffic, a band of light under the sleeve — a BRACELET; far off, somebody leaps between two roofs — a pair of SHOES. On "shoes" the camera pitches down toward the city.

EXT. THE ELEVATED LINE — NIGHT 3

Tracking alongside a train: WFC in every window. A pillar wipes the frame.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
And the gangs wore them first.

EXT. NEON AVENUE — NIGHT 4

Inches above the wet road, out from behind the pillar; a car tears through the foreground. JUNO and his two friends under a broken storefront sign. A slow push on Juno's bracelet: the light wakes, fills, goes red.

The shop window explodes — wide, from across the street, in slow motion: the impact, then the glass.

Through the glass of a bus shelter: a GIRL and her MOTHER, crouched. Red light washes across the girl's face from a van behind her.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Our streets became battlegrounds.
Our children grew up afraid.

WFC arrives, symmetrical and locked: vans from both ends of the avenue meet; officers step out in a line. Juno's friends run. A drone drops between Juno and the lens — its eye; three lights across his face.

WFC DRONE
Unregistered wearable detected.

Officers close. One takes his wrist. The bracelet goes dark. A click.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
The World Field Command is here to take this city back.

At boot height: the arrest. Boots, a fallen phone, his hand behind his back, the dead bracelet.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
To make New York safe again.

The camera cranes up the face of a tower to a billboard: THE DIRECTOR of the World Field Command, her face huge and calm. WFC. PROTECTING NEW YORK.

NEW YORK CITY · 2044

Smash cut to black.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — 21:58 5

Quiet. Fairy lights strung along the top of the wall under trailing ivy, close and soft.

THE OTHER ROBIN

A slow track along her wall: band posters, a moon, vinyl, *good things take time*, polaroids. The title gives way to the time.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — 21:58

The nightstand: a candle flickering, tulips, an instant camera. Her school ID hanging off the lamp — HARBOR HIGH · ROBIN RYU · GRADE 11. Her homework on the bed: AP Physics, problem set 6, due Friday, a doodle in the margin, the

pencil down. And at the foot of the bed, asleep on the knit throw, her black CAT. An ear flicks — as if it heard what is coming.

MUSIC IN: "Worth It" (from 2:14). Every cut lands on a beat.

A guitar string, vibrating; a pick across it; the riff. A whip pan past the amp and the cables onto ROBIN RYU (16), sprinting in. She lands on the bed, bounces, arms up, singing. The cat, bounced, opens one flat eye at her. It has seen this before.

Her room in four inserts: the sewing machine, a spark off the soldering iron; a jacket on a dress form, wiring in its seams; the business — boxes taped and labelled, a burner phone, cash under a mug; a pair of sneakers with coils in the soles, a car's light sliding across them.

She air-drums with two screwdrivers, hits the bench too hard — a component jumps — she catches it without looking. She stops. Her guitar, leaning on the amp. She picks it up, seriously, and kicks the amp on. Feedback.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — CONTINUOUS (THE GUITAR) 6

ROBIN · HER SONG — PLAY

> **PLAYABLE —** *A rhythm game. When the electric guitar comes in, a note highway rises on the right of the screen; the notes come down four lanes — ← ↓ ↑ → — and are hit as they reach the line. Hits keep the guitar in the song; a miss dips it. A streak builds a multiplier (×2, ×3, ×4); a rock meter shows how the room thinks it is going. ENTER skips.*

While she plays, the camera finds a new angle on her every two bars. Where the guitar drops out, the highway sinks away and the camera looks round her room on the beat: a chem test stamped SEE ME; cables across the floor to a power strip; homework on the floor stamped MISSING and LATE; her poster wall; a tangle of wire on the bench; a drafting board — ACTUATOR RIG v3, R. RYU, LAB 120, DO NOT TOUCH — with a Ψ-FIELD SENSOR circled in yellow; the cat; the cork board.

The last chord: a low hero angle. She jumps and lands on it.

ROBIN — LIVE FROM HER BEDROOM: STARS · NOTES HIT · BEST STREAK · SCORE

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — LATER 7

Back on the bed, the guitar on her chest, laughing at nobody. The song ends. Silence. The cat, moved to the shelf behind the bed, watches her, unimpressed. Her phone buzzes on the duvet — CANON. She answers without looking.

ROBIN
Mm.

CANON
You alive? You missed chem. Again.

ROBIN
I was there. Spiritually.

Up, pacing, phone to her ear — past the bench, the boxes, the form.

CANON
Teacher says one more missed lab write-up and she's calling home.

ROBIN
She can try.

ROBIN
Nobody's ever home.

The fridge clicks on somewhere in the flat. No light under her mother's door.

CANON
You're coming tomorrow, though. I'm not building that robot by myself.

ROBIN
Yes, Canon. I'll be there.

CANON
On time?

ROBIN
Don't push it.

The phone buzzes against her ear. She looks at it: UNKNOWN. The smile goes. Her eyes flick to the boxes.

ROBIN
Hold on. Let me call you back. I have to do something.

CANON
Robin, wait...

She switches calls.

THE BUYER (ON THE PHONE)
Hey. You got my order?

ROBIN
Yeah. It's ready.

The ring box, from above. It opens under her thumb: two rings, light travelling round each one.

She closes it. Alone in her room, the amp humming. Her phone: 22:15.

ROBIN
Okay.

The lamp goes off. On the shelf, in the dark, two gold eyes open and watch her go.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — NIGHT (THE KIT) 8

MUSIC IN: "Web of Silence" — the full beat as she gets ready. The lamp back on.

THE JACKET off the form; its seams wake up. THE GLOVES, at the bench. THE SHOES — down on one knee by the window; the soles go bright and the coils whine. THE BRACELET. THE BACKPACK — the ring box goes into it — and she heads for the door.

She stops. The music sinks.

INT. THE FLAT — KITCHEN — NIGHT 9

Dinner on the table, still covered. A note. The music almost gone, muffled.

NOTE: "DINNER'S IN THE FRIDGE. LOVE YOU. — MOM ♥"

She looks down the hall: her mother's door, dark. She picks the note up. Looks at it. Puts it back exactly where it was.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — NIGHT 10

THE WINDOW. The breakdown comes in from near silence. She slides the window up and the city comes in. Sunglasses on, at night.

Up onto the sill.

EXT. KILN STREET — 22:17 11

Outside, on the sill, five storeys over Kiln Street. A look down. A smile.

She jumps.

EXT. KILN STREET — CONTINUOUS (THE FALL) 12

The music holds its last beat before the drop, round and round, rising, while she falls — slowly.

THE SHOES · 1 / 6 — SPACE: FIRE THEM.

> **PLAYABLE —** *SPACE. The shoes fire — the song's drop lands on it — and she goes straight up past the roofs.*

EXT. THE ROOFS — NIGHT (THE LESSON) 13

The song carries the first roofs. The shoes teach themselves one thing at a time:

HOLD SPACE — THE SHOES PICK THE ROOF YOU ARE FACING (THE RING) AND TAKE YOU THERE.

KEEP HOLDING — EVERY LANDING SPRINGS INTO THE NEXT. THREE ROOFS IN A ROW.

POINT — LOOK WHERE YOU WANT TO GO. NORTH, OVER NEON AVENUE.

THE RHYTHM — TAP SPACE AS HER FEET TOUCH, WHEN THE RING GOES GOLD. TWO IN A ROW.

DRAGON ALLEY — THE BUYER IS IN DRAGON ALLEY. GET THERE.

> **PLAYABLE —** *Over the roofs to Dragon Alley. (The shoes do more: SHIFT in the air dives · SPACE out of a dive pulls up · SPACE at a wall kicks off it.)*

EXT. DRAGON ALLEY — 22:31 14

She walks in. THE BUYER and two of his crew at the bend.

THE BUYER
You got the stuff?

ROBIN
Yeah. You got the money?

THE BUYER
About that...

The rest of his crew step out of the dark behind him.

ROBIN
Oh.

ROBIN
You're gonna be annoying.

One of them takes the bag out of her hand.

ROBIN
Uh, no. That's actually mine.

THE BUYER
Not anymore.

A shove.

ROBIN
Okay.

The backpack comes off.

ROBIN
I really hate when people make me
do things twice.

> **PLAYABLE —** *THE FIGHT. It teaches itself, one move at a time; the world slows to a crawl at the instant that matters and waits for the key.*

ATTACK — THE FIRST ONE CHARGES. CLICK (OR K) TO HIT HIM.

ROBIN
See? That wasn't so hard.

DODGE — ANOTHER ONE SWINGS. SPACE AS THE FIST COMES.

COMBO — TWO RUSH HER. CLICK ×4: JAB, CROSS, HOOK, KICK.

ROBIN
Okay, there's a few more of you
than I expected.

BREAK — ONE GETS HOLD OF HER. G: THE BANGLE'S PULSE.

ROBIN
Definitely keeping that.

PARRY — ONE HAS A PIPE. RIGHT-CLICK (OR R) THE INSTANT BEFORE IT LANDS.

THE BUYER
GET HER!

ROBIN
Do you guys have, like, a group chat or something?

THE GAUNTLETS · POWER — HOLD CLICK, LET GO. PUT ONE THROUGH THE CAR.

THE DASH — F: STRAIGHT TO THE ONE YOU ARE FACING.

EVERYTHING — USE ALL OF IT. EVERY ONE OF THEM DOWN.

ONE MORE — HE IS GETTING BACK UP.

THUG
You're gonna regret this!

ROBIN
People keep saying that.

ROBIN
Anybody else?

ROBIN
Great.

The ones still standing run. She walks to the buyer in his corner and picks up the bag.

ROBIN
So...

ROBIN
My money?

Nothing.

ROBIN
Right. Worth a shot.

The buyer bolts. Her phone buzzes: a number she doesn't know.

UNKNOWN NUMBER (TEXT)
 You just cost us a lot of money.

ROBIN
Yeah?

ROBIN
Send me an invoice.

THE BAG, AND THE RINGS IN IT. NO MONEY.

EXT. NEON AVENUE — 23:02 15

Out of the alley with the bag. Across the avenue the billboard: WFC. PROTECTING NEW YORK.

ROBIN
Yeah. Sure.

The screen changes: CITIZEN ALERT — SECTOR 9 — DRAGON ALLEY.

ROBIN
...Huh.

A drone drops in her face and reads her gloves.

WFC DRONE
UNREGISTERED WEARABLE DETECTED.

Vans from both ends of the avenue. Officers pouring out.

WFC OFFICER
THERE! DROP THE BAG! GET ON THE GROUND!

ROBIN
Okay, little weird.

ROBIN
Actually...

THE CHASE 16

> **PLAYABLE —** *The shoes are cold from the fight: on foot. A red ring on the ground is a missile — get out of it.*

THE CHASE · 1 — RUN. EAST, DOWN NEON AVENUE. SHIFT SPRINTS; SPACE VAULTS A BARRIER.

WFC OFFICER
STOP!

ROBIN
You're really committed to this!

ROBIN
Are you KIDDING me?!

THE CHASE · 2 — CORNERED. A WFC CAR BRAKES ACROSS THE PAVEMENT.

WFC OFFICER
END OF THE LINE, KID.

ROBIN
Okay. Fine.

PLAYABLE — *WFC · FIGHT 1 / 3.*

ROBIN
Sorry! Reflex!

THE CHASE · 3 — RUN. NORTH, INTO THE GAP BETWEEN THE BUILDINGS. IF IT CLOSES: G, AND UP THE WALL.

A WFC barrier slams down across the gap.

ROBIN
Okay. Okay okay okay.

ROBIN
Please work.

WFC OFFICER
She's on the building!

ROBIN
Yeah. I noticed.

ROBIN
Okay. That's new.

THE CHASE · 4 — HOLD SPACE. THE SHOES ARE CHARGED: ROOF TO ROOF, EAST.

ROBIN
Okay, Robin. Don't embarrass yourself.

ROBIN
Okay. Definitely keeping that.

EXT. ROOFTOP — NIGHT 17

An alarm. The gunship drops a team on the roof in front of her; a gate slams across the way on.

WFC OFFICER
SUSPECT CONTAINED.

ROBIN
Seriously?!

ROBIN
...Okay.

ROBIN
Oh, come on.

WFC OFFICER
HANDS WHERE I CAN SEE THEM!

ROBIN
Yeah, I'm gonna pass on that.

PLAYABLE — *WFC · FIGHT 2 / 3.*

ROBIN
Who even trains you guys?

THE CHASE · 6 — E: HIDE. YOU CANNOT OUTRUN A GUNSHIP. BEHIND THE AC UNIT — AND STAY ON THE FAR SIDE OF WHATEVER IS LOOKING.

WFC OFFICER
SUSPECT IS ON THE ROOFTOPS. ALL UNITS, SECTOR 9.

A searchlight sweeps the roof. She gets behind the AC unit.

ROBIN
Shhh.

Her phone rings. MOM.

ROBIN
Oh, you've gotta be kidding me.

MOM — KEEP TALKING. KEEP THE BOX BETWEEN YOU AND HIM.

An officer walks round the box toward the sound.

ROBIN
Hey, Mom.

MOM (ON THE PHONE)
Hey, Robin. I'm still at work. I think I'm going to be later than usual tonight.

ROBIN
Okay. Yeah. No problem.

MOM (ON THE PHONE)
You okay? You sound out of breath.

ROBIN
Yeah. I'm fine. Just... stairs.

MOM (ON THE PHONE)
What was that?

ROBIN
Uh... TV.

MOM (ON THE PHONE)
At this hour?

ROBIN
Really good TV.

MOM (ON THE PHONE)
Alright. Don't stay up too late.

ROBIN
Yeah. You too.

ROBIN
...Crap.

THE CHASE · 8 — FOUND. HE CAME ROUND THE BOX.

PLAYABLE — *WFC · FIGHT 3 / 3.*

THE CHASE · 9 — GET HOME. LOSE THEM, AND LAND ON YOUR OWN ROOF WITH NOBODY ON YOU.

PLAYABLE — *Everything at once: the gunship strafing, drones, officers. Lose every star, then home.*

EXT. ROOFTOP — 214 HARBOR LANE 18

Her own roof. She drops to one knee.

ROBIN
Okay...

ROBIN
Definitely never doing that again.

ROBIN
...Probably.

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — NIGHT 19

In at the window. The room dark. Her phone says 3:07. School in the morning.

ROBIN
Rats.

Everything off, onto the floor, and into bed.

EXT. ROOFTOP ACROSS KILN STREET — NIGHT 20

Two people on a roof with binoculars, watching her window: MAYA and KAI.

MAYA
That's her.

KAI
You're sure?

MAYA
Yeah.

And then they come out of her back — arms, four of them, rearing up over Maya's shoulder while she stares down the lens.

CUT TO BLACK.

END OF PROLOGUE — SOMEBODY HAS NOTICED HER.

THE OTHER ROBIN — THE MORNING AFTER

INT. ROBIN'S ROOM — MORNING 21

Sun in at the window. An alarm that has been going for a while: 8:42. School started at 8:00.

ROBIN
Rats.

School clothes, the backpack — and the boots by the window.

ROBIN
You're up.

EXT. KILN STREET — 8:44 AM 22

> **PLAYABLE —** *Out of the window into daylight and over the roofs the way she went last night — no heat, no drones, no WFC. A school day.*

EXT. ROOFTOP — HARBOR LANE HIGH SCHOOL — 8:57 AM 23

ROBIN
Okay. Technically not that late.

And over the edge.

INT. HARBOR LANE HIGH — 9:01 AM 24

In through the revolving door. The atrium.

SECURITY GUARD
Morning, Robin.

ROBIN
Morning.

SECURITY GUARD
Long night?

ROBIN
You could say that.

And across the lobby, her TEACHER.

ROBIN
...Nope.

> **PLAYABLE —** *THE SNEAK. Get to class without your teacher seeing you. Her teacher walks a round and sees down a cone in front of her; inside it a meter fills. Walls, a passing student, the bulletin board (E: read it) and the bathroom (E: wait it out) are cover.*

However it goes — seen, or the PA catches up with her:

PA (V.O.)
Robin, please report to Room 120.
Robin, Room 120.

TEACHER
Robin.

ROBIN
I was here yesterday.

TEACHER
That's not really how attendance works.

ROBIN
Worth a shot.

TEACHER
Assignment six-two?

TEACHER
You know what's frustrating?

ROBIN
The fact that I'm standing here?

TEACHER
The fact that I know you could have finished this in an hour.

TEACHER
Come on. I need your help.

ROBIN
So I'm not in trouble?

TEACHER
You're absolutely in trouble.

ROBIN
Okay.

TEACHER
But you're also useful.

INT. ROBOTICS LAB — ROOM 120 25

Not a classroom: a containment rig with a few centimetres of violet light held in it.

TEACHER
This is what I've been working on.

TEACHER
We're calling it Psi Energy.

TEACHER
Honestly? We don't completely understand it yet.

TEACHER
We've managed to hold a tiny field. It's unstable. But it's real.

TEACHER
The problem is the prototype. Every time we expose it to the field, it malfunctions.

The prototype — the actuator rig from her drafting board — goes into the field and malfunctions.

TEACHER
The energy output spikes whenever the actuator—

ROBIN
Because the actuator is compensating.

TEACHER
What?

ROBIN
You're telling it to maintain a constant output while the Psi field is fluctuating.

ROBIN
It's fighting itself.

TEACHER
That's why I keep you around.

> **PLAYABLE —** *At the stand: route the Psi energy · match its frequency · stabilise the actuators.*

It runs, in the field.

TEACHER
You did it.

ROBIN
Obviously.

TEACHER
You know, most people wait until I finish explaining the problem.

ROBIN
Most people aren't me.

TEACHER
(laughs)

TEACHER
That's exactly what I'm worried about.

TEACHER
You're brilliant, Robin. You know that, right?

ROBIN
I've heard.

TEACHER
No. I don't think you have.

TEACHER
You have the kind of intuition that could take you somewhere extraordinary.

TEACHER
But you're late. You're missing assignments. You're exhausted. You're somewhere else half the time.

TEACHER
I don't care about one late assignment. I care that you're starting to disappear.

TEACHER
You could be one of the best roboticists I've ever taught.

TEACHER
Your mom knows how talented you are.

TEACHER
She'd be proud to see what you're capable of.

It hits her.

ROBIN
Yeah.

ROBIN
I should get to class.

EXT. HARBOR LANE HIGH — 3:20 PM 26

Through the doors into the sun; students everywhere. Headphones in. She walks — not bouncing now — and looks up at the city, and past it at the sky.

Her phone. CANON: *you coming?* — ROBIN: *where?* — CANON: *old harbor lane station. trust me*

EXT. HARBOR LANE STATION — DAY 27

Canon, by the boarded-up stair of a station closed since before they were born.

CANON
You came.

ROBIN
You said "trust me." That's never good.

CANON
It's always good.

ROBIN
It's never good, Canon.

CANON
It's sometimes good.

CANON
Harbor Lane Station. Closed since before we were born.

ROBIN
And we're going in because...

CANON
Because nobody else does.

INT. HARBOR LANE STATION — CLOSED 28

Dark.

CANON
Power's dead. The whole line.

ROBIN
It's not dead. It's disconnected.

> **PLAYABLE —** *RESTORE THE POWER — the breaker is fine, the feed is not: turn the pieces until power runs from the mains to the lights.*

The lights come on down the line, one after another, with a flicker.

CANON
Okay. That was cool.

ROBIN
That was a breaker.

CANON
A cool breaker.

They walk the tunnel.

CANON
So what's the thing your teacher has you working on?

ROBIN
It's an actuator rig.

CANON
So, a robot.

ROBIN
...Fine. A robot.

CANON
And?

ROBIN
It kept fighting itself. The field it sits in moves, and it wasn't moving with it.

CANON
And you fixed it.

ROBIN
I listened to it.

CANON
You talk about machines like they're people.

ROBIN
Machines are easier.

CANON
Than people?

ROBIN
Than you.

CANON
I'll take that as a compliment.

ROBIN
It wasn't one.

CANON
The barrier's tied to the old signal switch.

ROBIN
Then we throw the switch.

> **PLAYABLE —** *THROW THE SWITCH — line every notch of the gears up with the lever. The barrier to the tracks lifts.*

Near a crack in the tunnel wall, Canon's homemade gizmo starts to hum.

CANON
Okay. I want to show you something. Don't laugh.

ROBIN
No promises.

CANON
I built it out of a dead phone and a radio. It picks something up down here.

ROBIN
Picks up what?

CANON
I don't know. It just hums. Only in the tunnels.

ROBIN
That's not noise.

CANON
What is it?

ROBIN
It's a field. It's oscillating.

ROBIN
It's like the field in the lab.

CANON
What lab?

ROBIN
My teacher keeps Psi energy in a containment rig. A few centimetres of it.

ROBIN
It's not supposed to be loose down here.

CANON
Can you make it read it properly?

ROBIN
If I match it.

PLAYABLE — *TUNE IT TO THE FIELD — make the gizmo's wave match the field's: count the humps, line up the peaks.*

CANON
You just tuned something you've never seen before.

ROBIN
It's the same wave as the lab. You just have to match it.

CANON
Keep it.

ROBIN
It's yours.

CANON
I built it. You're the one who understands it.

A hatch, high in the wall.

ROBIN
There's a hatch.

CANON
Two and a half metres up.

ROBIN
Boost me.

CANON
And then what? I live down here now?

ROBIN
And then I pull you up.

He boosts her; she pulls him up. For a second neither of them lets go.

CANON
Hi.

ROBIN
Hi.

CANON
You can let go now.

ROBIN
Right. Yes.

The passage beyond.

CANON
Can I tell you something?

ROBIN
You're going to anyway.

CANON
I like this.

ROBIN
The tunnel?

CANON
Down here. With you.

ROBIN
...It's a tunnel, Canon.

CANON
It's a nice tunnel.

ROBIN
It's an okay tunnel.

A security door. A sign.

CANON
"No admittance. WFC."

ROBIN
Since when does the WFC own a dead station?

CANON
Since when does the WFC ask?

> **PLAYABLE —** *WHY WON'T IT OPEN — the keypad takes Canon's guess (1-2-3-4) and the door does not move. Check it, then say what is wrong.*

INT. HARBOR LANE STATION — THE OLD PLATFORM 29

An abandoned train, its door open. Out of it: MAYA and KAI.

MAYA
Well. Look at this.

CANON
Who are you?

MAYA
Nobody. Same as you.

KAI
Two kids in a dead station. Cute.

CANON
This place is closed.

KAI
So why are you in it?

CANON
Why are you?

MAYA
Same reason as everybody down here. Nobody looks.

CANON
You're not WFC.

KAI
Do we look WFC?

MAYA
The WFC sealed this station and forgot about it. That's what they do.

CANON
Yeah. Nobody down here likes the WFC.

KAI
Finally. Somebody gets it.

MAYA
They're scared of one girl in a pair of shoes. YU.

ROBIN
People exaggerate.

MAYA
Do they?

MAYA
What's that in your pocket? It's singing.

ROBIN
Nothing.

KAI
Hand it over.

The gizmo in Robin's pocket sings louder as Maya gets close.

CANON
Robin. Get behind me.

ROBIN
Canon, don't—

CANON
I said get behind me.

KAI
Brave.

KAI
Stupid. But brave.

Kai puts Canon on the floor.

ROBIN
Canon!

KAI.

PLAYABLE — *THE FIGHT — Kai, and his great sword.*

Kai down. Maya walks in.

MAYA
You don't fight like a kid.

ROBIN
I took a lot of self-defence classes.

MAYA
Mm. So did I.

Maya's arms come out of her back — four of them.

PLAYABLE — *THE FIGHT — Maya: claws, lunges, and the platform's junk thrown at you. Keep moving.*

In the scuffle the gizmo slips out of Robin's jacket and hits the platform. It beeps — faster and faster, red each time. Nobody moves.

MAYA
What is that? Turn it off.

ROBIN
I can't!

MAYA
Turn. It. OFF.

KAI
Maya?

MAYA
Get... away...

What is in Maya answers it. Black smoke bursts out of her and hangs — and then it does not stop. It comes up out of her and keeps coming until it is the size of the platform: ALPHA, heaving, pale lights opening and shutting all over it.

KAI
No. No, no, no.

KAI
Maya, stop!

Canon goes into it.

ROBIN
CANON!

ROBIN
Give him back.

PLAYABLE — *SHE FIGHTS IT FOR HIM. It rears back before it bites — DODGE (be out of reach, or SPACE). A bite that misses leaves it open — HIT IT!*

ROBIN
I said GIVE HIM BACK!

PLAYABLE — *AND THEN SHE REALLY FIGHTS IT. Four passes, each ending with it on her — SPACE, as fast as you can, to break free: a flying kick into its jaw; under it, a backflip and a spin kick into its eye; leaning into its roar; and everything she has, from higher than she has ever gone.*

ROBIN
Get out of here, Robin. Get out.
Go. GO.

PLAYABLE — *RUN — the green EXIT, straight ahead.*

EXT. HARBOR LANE — 4:40 PM 30

Up the ladder into the afternoon. It does not come up after her. It stays down there.

ROBIN
...It's not coming up.

ROBIN
It stayed down there.

WFC — all round her.

WFC OFFICER
FREEZE! WFC! Hands where we can see them!

WFC OFFICER
It's YU. She was down there with that thing.

ROBIN
Wait— no, you don't understand—

WFC OFFICER
A boy went into Harbor Lane Station this afternoon and never came out. Canon Cortez. Where is he?

ROBIN
It took him! That thing took him, I tried to—

WFC OFFICER
It chased her across half the city and never laid a hand on her.

WFC OFFICER
She's with it. Take her DOWN!

ROBIN
...I'm sorry.

PLAYABLE — *RUN. The Meridian Tower, east of everything: get to the top.*

EXT. THE MERIDIAN TOWER 31

PLAYABLE — *Straight up 140 metres of glass, the gunship's light climbing after her.*

EXT. THE ROOF — THE MERIDIAN TOWER — NIGHT 32

Five WFC fighters rise round the roof out of the dark below its edge. Her mother's voice on their speakers.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
YU. Look around you.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Every ship I have is on this roof. Stand down.

ROBIN
(thinking)
Of course she brought an army.

PLAYABLE — *THE FLEET — they make their runs one at a time (a red line, then the guns walk it). A spent ship sinks smoking to the edge: jump on and CLICK to bring it down. All five.*

The gunship comes down onto the pad. Out of its light steps THE DIRECTOR of WFC — alone. Robin's mother. She has no idea who is under the mask.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
That's far enough.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
A station torn open. My people in the hospital. A boy nobody can find.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Whatever you are, it ends on this roof.

ROBIN
(thinking)
Mom.

ROBIN
(thinking)
She can't find out it's me. Not like this.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Take the bird up. Nobody else comes near this roof.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
I'll do this myself.

The rain starts as they square up.

THE DIRECTOR. — YOUR MOTHER. SHE DOESN'T KNOW IT'S YOU.

PLAYABLE — *THE DIRECTOR — her charge (she powers up, then crosses the roof in an instant: be out of line), her volleys of junk, her taser line.*

At half her strength the fight stops. She touches her ear.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Bring the bird around.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Light her up.

PLAYABLE — *The gunship comes up over the edge and turns its guns on Robin — get out of the red.*

Robin has her mother down, in the rain.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Who... are you?

ROBIN
(thinking)
I'm sorry, Mom.

She goes off the edge.

LATER 33

Somewhere dark, on her own, she stops — and it all comes down on her. She calls him.

ROBIN
Pick up. Pick up, pick up, please.

ROBIN
Canon, it's me. Please. Just... tell me you're okay.

ROBIN
I'm so sorry. I'm gonna get you back. I promise.

PLAYABLE — *GET HOME — over the roofs, however you like. Her own roof. Her window. One final jump.*

INT. ROBIN'S BEDROOM — NIGHT 34

She takes it all off and goes to wash the night away. While the water runs, somebody lets themselves in: boots across her floor, a badge set down on her bench, a voice on a phone.

MOM
It's me. I'm at the residence.

MOM
No. Nothing yet.

MOM
Then widen it. Every unit we have.

The lamp comes on. It is her mother — the Director of WFC.

MOM
Sit down.

MOM
Canon Cortez is gone.

MOM
Taken out of Harbor Lane Station this afternoon, in front of half the city.

ROBIN
What... what happened to him?

MOM
Don't look at me like that. You were seen near that station today.

MOM
Something tore its way up out of the ground. And YU was standing right next to it.

MOM
That boy is gone because of her. YU, and whatever she dragged up out of the dark.

MOM
As of an hour ago, every officer in this city is hunting her. For the abduction, and possible murder, of Canon Cortez.

MOM
And when I find her, Robin...

MOM
...she will never see daylight again.

Robin cannot say a word of what is true. So she says nothing.

ROBIN RYU — THE END

THE END